

Everybody's doing the DMCA

Under the Digital Millennium Copyright Acts (DCMA) section 512, a copyright holder can send a 'take-down' notice to an ISP whose network is used for distributing copyrighted music and other files. The Recording Industry Association of America (RIAA) sent 24 notices, without confirming that the files were available for download. CNet News reported that the RIAA

withdrew the notice sent to the Penn State University by a temporary worker and apologised for the incident.

In another case, an ISP called Speakeasy received a notice stating that a certain user's Web site was illegally offering approximately 0 sound files for download, including songs

by artistes such as Creed. Speakeasy reverted back and was satisfied with their timely response.

Even after such incidents, the RIAA continues its threatening stance. One of their ideas is to warn users against file swapping by using the instant messaging found within peer-to-peer software.



DVD next

Toshiba and NEC have developed a prototype of what they tout as the next generation of DVD technology. The prototype was unveiled at Optical Data Storage 2003 show, held in Vancouver. This technology differs from the Blu-Ray format.

The disc is based on shorter length blue lasers as com-

pared to current red-laser technologies, but it would be easier to make backward compatible with current DVD technology. Current production facilities would require comparatively lesser modifications to mass-produce the new discs called Advanced Optical Disc (AOD). The proposed format utilizes the same

disk structure used in current DVDs—back-to-back bonding of two 0.6 mm thick, 120 mm disks. Toshiba claims to have stored 36 GB of data on a dual-layer, single-sided, read-and-write disk.

Toshiba and NEC are working with an association of 215 companies to define the future format.

redalert

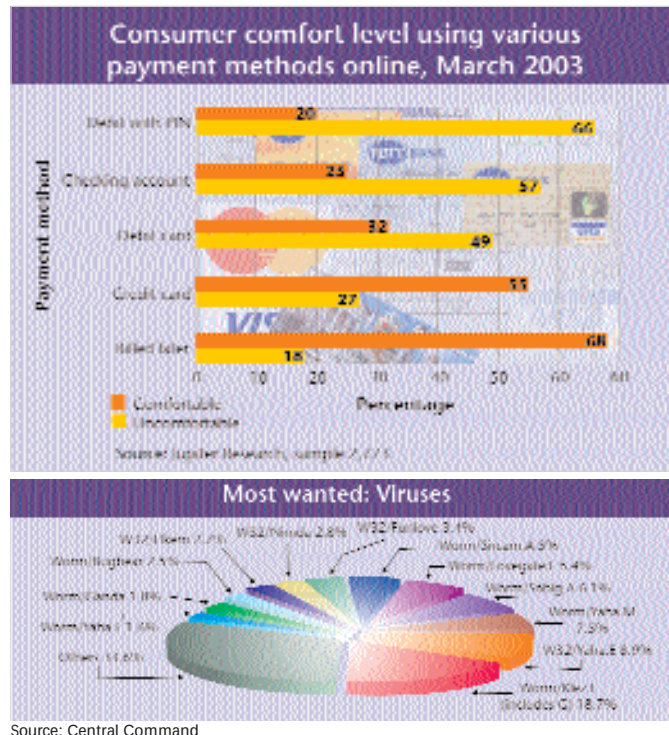
Freaky fizz

A new worm called W32.HLLW.Fizzer@mm arrives as an e-mail attachment having a .com, .exe, .pif or .scr extension. It sends itself to all windows address book contacts, independent of the e-mail software. It also spreads itself via the KaZaA file-sharing network. Fizzer has a key logger that can be used to steal passwords and other sensitive data. This sneaky worm attempts to disable your anti-virus software and updates itself automatically. It can be remotely controlled via IRC and AOL's messenger for distributed denial of service (DDoS) attacks. All versions of Windows are at risk. Check for the latest virus updates or visit <http://www.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.hllw.fizzer@mm.html> for a removal.

Maax hit

W32.HLLW.Maax.B@mm, is a worm that spreads through e-mail. It uses MAPI programs to mail itself to all your contacts. The e-mail contains a subject from the worm's pre-determined list, and contains a file called Tca.exe. It attempts to disable any anti-virus and then deletes several system files. It also makes modifications to your system.ini and win.ini files. If it succeeds in modifying the autoexec.bat file, your C and D drives may be formatted when you restart. Visit <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.hllw.maax.b@mm.html> for a removal.

statattack



Son for sale

A man, who offered his son for sale on the Internet in jest, was in trouble when a concerned Web surfer informed the police. Alex Wilson of Scotland placed an advertisement about 2 years ago to tease his son Liam, who was then 5 years old. After placing the advertisement, he forgot about it until this Canadian woman spotted it on a Web site selling bicycles and prams, and informed the police. The advertisement read, "Hyperactive kid for sale, good at vacuuming, not great at washing dishes because he's too short. Guaranteed to annoy. Five pounds or nearest offer."

Alex had to remove the advertisement from the site.

■ "Most Web sites that display lyrics of songs are breaking the law", Sarah Faulder, chief executive of the Music Publishers Association